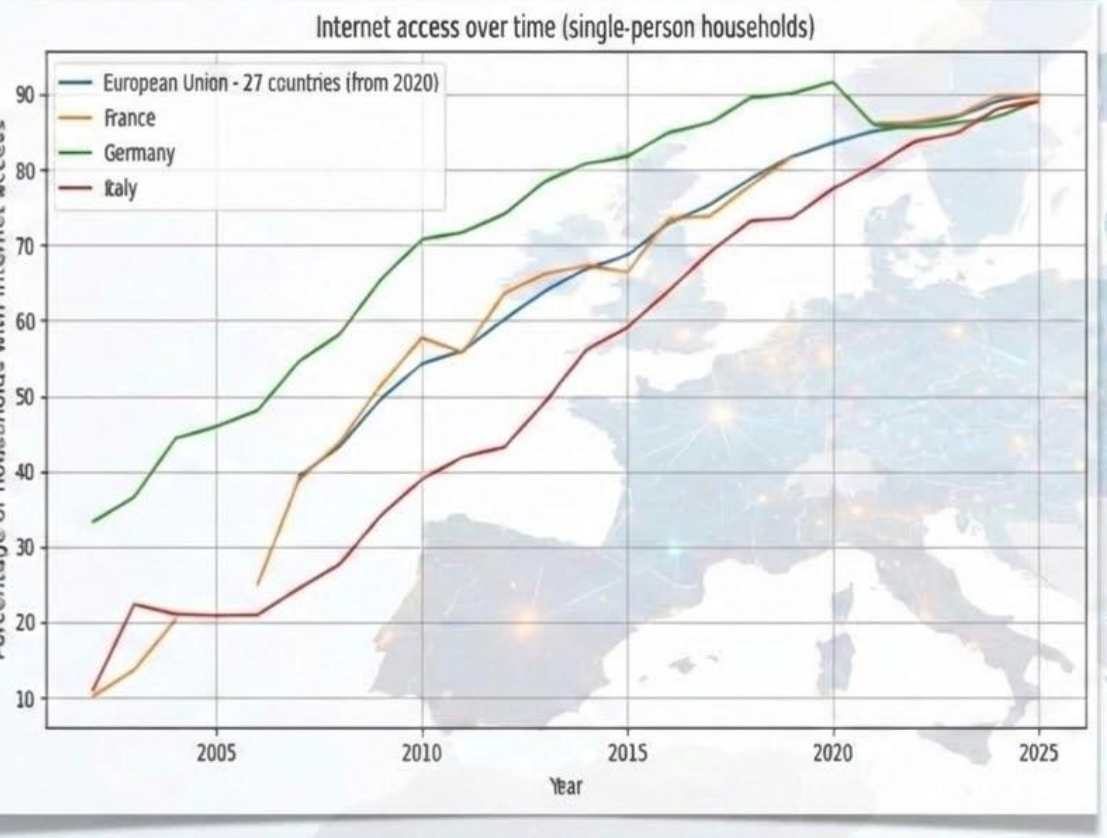


Internet Access Among Single-Person Households in Europe

Trends and cross-country differences

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Research questions

Primary research question

How has internet access evolved over time among single-person households across European countries?

Secondary research questions

- How does Italy compare with the EU average and other major European countries?
- Which countries show the highest levels of internet access in the most recent year?
- Do differences in access across countries still persist?

About Data

Dataset

- Eurostat – *Households: level of internet access*

Data selection

- The dataset provides official, comparable statistics across European countries and over time.
- Alternative sources were discarded due to limited coverage or lack of cross-country comparability.

License

- The dataset is published as open data by Eurostat and can be reused with attribution.
- This work complies with open data requirements and is shared under a Creative Commons license.

About Data

Data quality and limitations

- Some country–year observations are missing, especially for the most recent years.
- The data are survey-based and may reflect methodological differences across countries.
- The dataset does not include urban–rural distinctions.

Data cleaning

- Only annual observations were retained.
- Values were filtered to percentages of households.
- Single-person households were selected to ensure consistency in household structure

Methodology

Data preparation

- The dataset was imported and processed using standard data preparation steps
- Only annual observations were retained
- Values were filtered to percentages of households
- Single-person households were selected to ensure comparability

Analysis

- Time-series analysis to examine long-term trends
- Cross-sectional analysis to compare countries in the most recent year
- Aggregation and reshaping of data to create visualization-ready tables

Visualization tools

- Datawrapper: time-series line chart
- Flourish: country comparison visualization

Reproducibility

- The analysis can be replicated using the same Eurostat dataset and the described filtering and comparison steps.

Insights from the Data

Insights

- Internet access among single-person households has increased steadily across Europe.
- Differences between countries have narrowed over time, indicating convergence.
- Countries with lower initial access levels often experienced faster growth.
- Despite overall progress, cross-country disparities remain visible in the most recent data.

Operations performed

- Trend analysis across years
- Cross-country comparison
- Ranking of countries by latest-year values

Title

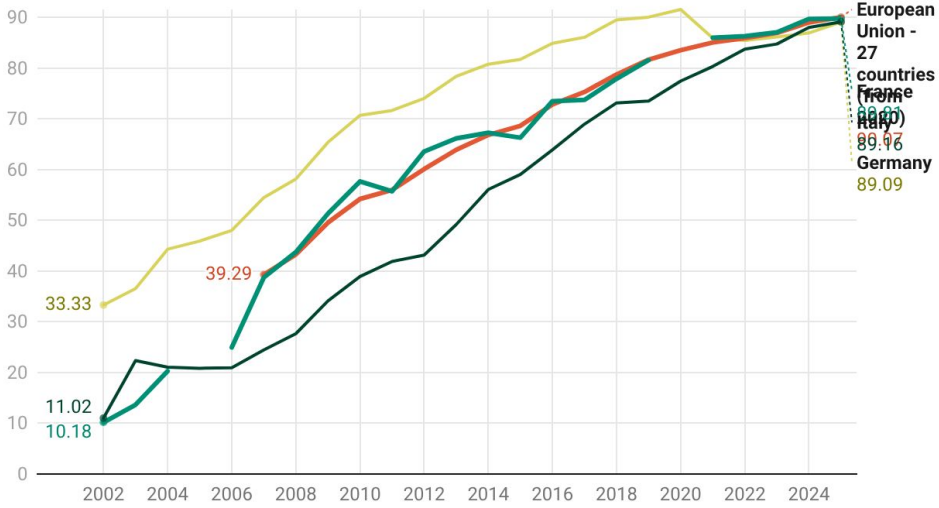
Evolution of internet access among single-person households

Explanation

- The graph illustrates the evolution of internet access among single-person households in Italy, Germany, France, and the European Union average from the early 2000s to the most recent year available.

Internet access among single-person households in selected European countries

This chart shows the evolution of internet access among single-person households in Italy, Germany, France, and the European Union average from the early 2000s to the most recent year available. All countries exhibit a strong upward trend, indicating widespread diffusion of internet access over time.

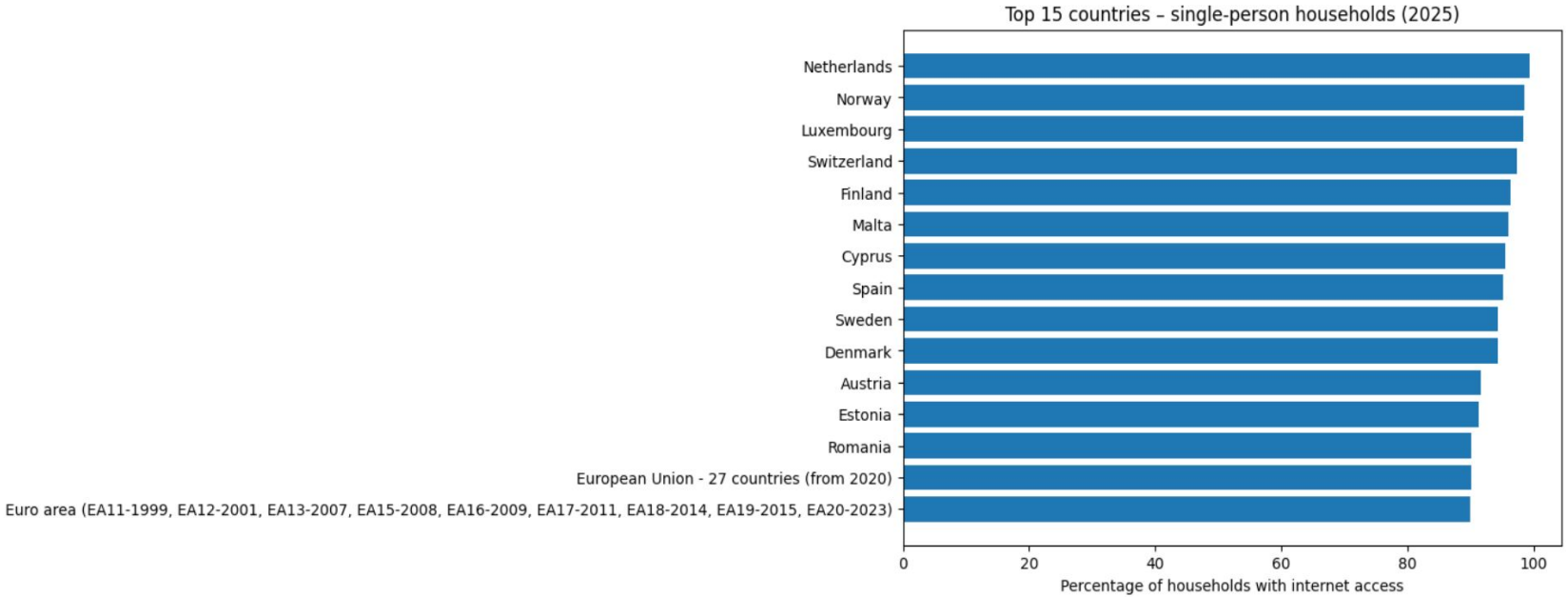


Values represent the percentage of single-person households with internet access.

Chart: Mahsa Bahri • Source: eurostat • Created with Datawrapper

- Germany and the EU average show higher initial access levels, while Italy and France start from lower values. From the mid-2000s onward, all countries experience rapid growth, reflecting improvements in infrastructure and affordability. Over time, gaps between countries narrow substantially, and Italy shows strong catch-up dynamics. In the most recent years, access levels converge toward high values, approaching saturation and indicating near-universal internet access among single-person households.

Link to the Datawrapper graph



Title

Internet access among single-person households across European countries (latest year)

Explanation

- The figure compares European countries based on the percentage of single-person households with internet access in the most recent year available. Most countries report access levels above 90%, indicating widespread connectivity across Europe.

- Countries such as the Netherlands, Norway, and Luxembourg lead the ranking, reflecting sustained investments in digital infrastructure and high levels of digital literacy.
- Despite the overall high access levels observed in the chart, the ranking also reveals that cross-country differences persist. Northern and Western European countries tend to occupy the highest positions, while other countries, particularly from Southern and Eastern Europe, appear lower in the ranking or are absent from the top group. These differences suggest that the timing and speed of internet adoption have varied across countries, likely influenced by economic conditions, infrastructure development, and national digital policies.

Link to the Flourish graph

LICENCE

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